

OIL ANALYST

Reducing Our Price Forecast on Deal to Reopen Hormuz

- **Reducing price forecast.** We reduce our oil price forecast following President Trump's announcement of an interim deal that would lift the US blockade, and reopen the Strait of Hormuz after a scheduled deal signing on Friday ([Exhibit 1](#)). While full details on the agreement are unclear, we now assume that Persian Gulf exports normalize to pre-war levels by the end of July (vs. end of August previously). We are reducing our 2026Q4 Brent forecast to \$80 (vs. \$90 previously) and to \$75 (vs. \$80 prior) for the 2027 average ([Exhibit 1](#), consistent with our [estimate](#) that moving the supply normalization process one month forward reduces the fair value of crude prices for 2026Q4/2027 by around \$10/\$5, respectively. We now expect WTI to average \$75 in 2026Q4 and \$70 in 2027.
- **Risks around Mideast supply.** The risks around our assumption that exports/production from the Persian Gulf recover to their pre-war levels by end-July and October ([Exhibit 2](#)), respectively, are two-sided.¹
 - The supply recovery might be stronger because:
 - This normalization in oil exports from Gulf producers to their pre-war level might be achieved with a 12mb/d increase in Hormuz flows from current levels to just 70% of pre-war levels ([Exhibit 3](#)). We estimate that Gulf flows have already risen to 11mb/d with increases in both Hormuz flows and redirections ([Exhibit 4](#)).
 - Producers such as Saudi Arabia and the UAE might respond more strongly to low OECD commercial stocks ([Exhibit 12](#)) this summer with even larger production increases than our above pre-war levels base case.
 - Iran production might rise above pre-war levels on potential sanctions relief ([Exhibit 5](#)).
 - The supply recovery might be weaker because:
 - A potential resumption in regional hostilities/strikes on ships might keep shippers risk-averse, and keep exports and production at low

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¹ Tanker capacity is unlikely to be a binding constraint with an estimated capacity of empty tankers within the Strait or within 5 days of navigation to load 860 million barrels, which corresponds to over 40 days of 20mb/d of normal Hormuz exports.

levels for longer.

- Clearing any potential mines might require significant time (although alternative routes can be used in the meantime).
- Iran might effectively close the Strait again even after re-opening, for instance if detailed nuclear talks don't succeed.

■ **Resilient 2027 prices vs. large surplus.** We now also forecast a somewhat firmer demand recovery ([Exhibit 6](#)) in 2026H2-2027 on improved affordability. We forecast resilient 2027 Brent/WTI prices in line with our long-term fair values of \$75/70 despite a large 3.2mb/d 2027 surplus because:

- OECD commercial oil stocks are unlikely to reach very high levels following large 2026H1 draws and a structural trend of global strategic stockpiling of over 1mb/d in 2027 ([Exhibit 7](#)).
- Some security premium compensating for disruption risk is likely to keep a floor under prices.
 - That said, managing the sharpest oil production shock ever of 14mb/d with a smaller-than-expected 5mb/d deficit in Q2 ([Exhibit 8](#)) on remarkable flexibility (especially from China demand) and without sustained extreme prices is also likely to cap this security premium (assuming Mideast exports recover fast).

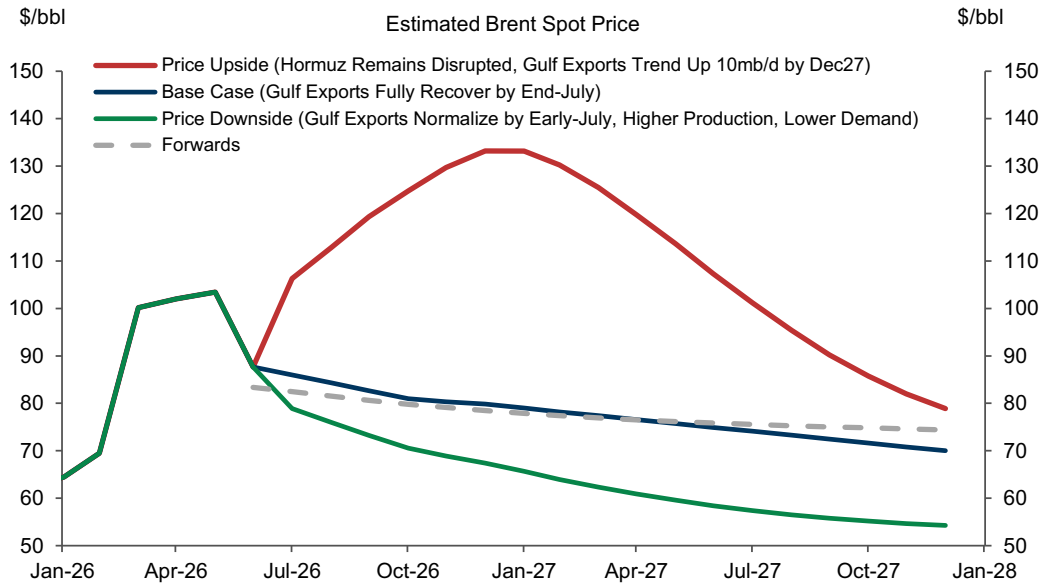
■ **Two-sided but still net upside price risks.**

- *Price upside scenario:* Brent might rise above \$130 in late 2026 and average \$105 in 2027 ([Exhibit 9](#)) assuming Hormuz remains disrupted through 2027 with Gulf countries' exports rising gradually by 10mb/d by Dec27 (with some expansion in allowed Hormuz flows and/or pipeline capacity).²
- *Price downside scenario:* Brent might average just under \$70 in 2026Q4 and just under \$60 in 2027 assuming exports normalize by early July, stickier demand losses, and stronger supply.³

² We see some upside risk to these price estimates (which rely on the historically linear relationship between total oil inventories and crude prices), and would expect even larger price increases for tight refined products such as diesel, where historical data show non-linear price increases when inventories fall from already low levels.

³ The price downside scenario assumes stickier demand losses (with 1.5mb/d or 30% of the peak nearly 5mb/d demand loss persisting in 2027 vs. just over 10% in the baseline), and stronger global supply (+1.4mb/d higher in 2027 than the baseline), for instance in the UAE, Brazil, and the US.

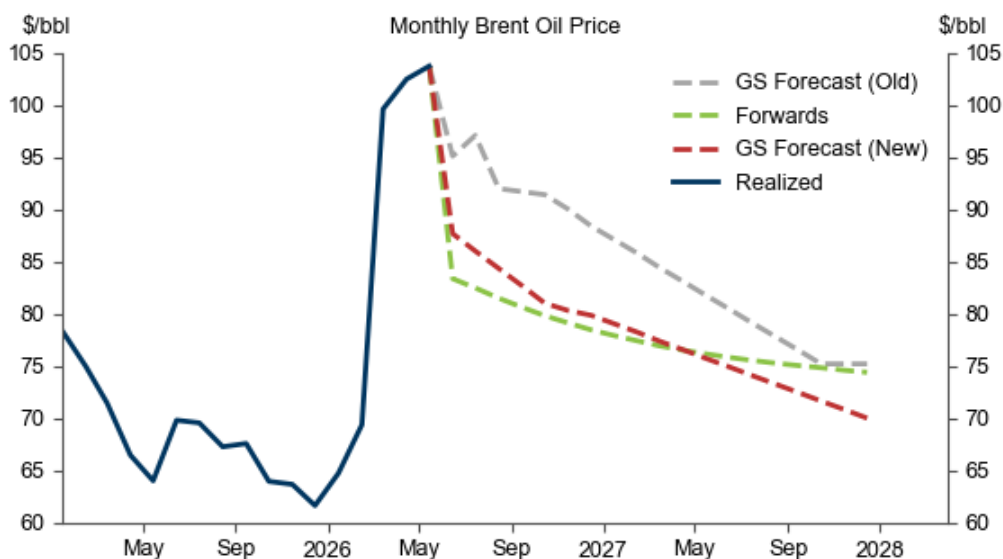
We See Risks to Our Brent Price Forecast as Two-Sided but Tilted to the Upside on Net



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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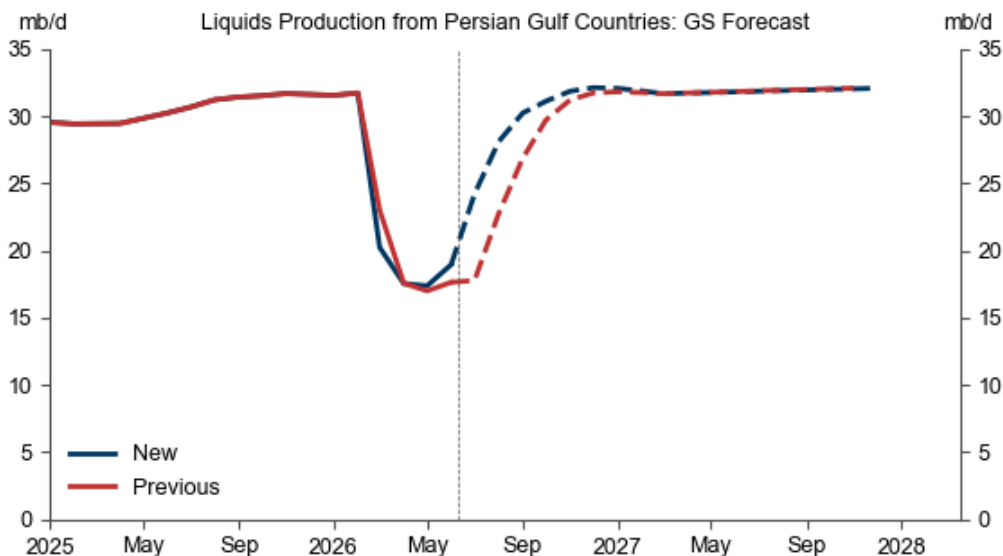
Exhibit 1: We Are Reducing Our 2026Q4 Brent Forecast to \$80 and to \$75 for the 2027 Average as We Now Assume an Earlier Recovery in Mideast Supply Following a Deal to Reopen Hormuz



Source: ICE, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Assuming an Earlier Normalization of Gulf Exports by End of July

Exhibit 2: We Now Assume That Oil Exports/Production from Persian Gulf Countries Recovers by End of July/October, Respectively

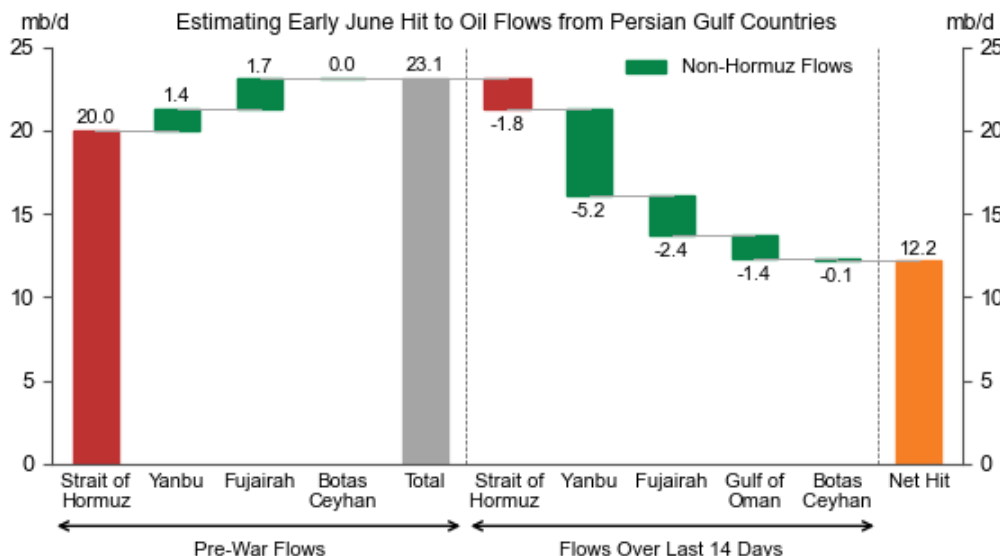


Included countries: Iran, Iraq, Kuwait, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, United Arab Emirates. Liquids include crude oil and natural gas liquids (NGLs).

Source: OPEC Secondary Sources, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Two-Sided Risks to the Mideast Supply Recovery

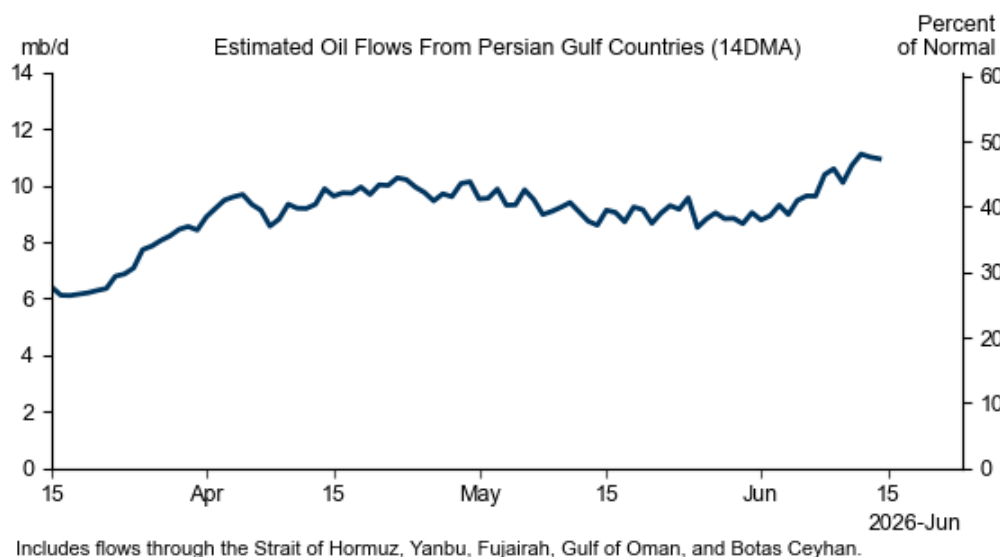
Exhibit 3: This Normalization in Oil Exports From Gulf Producers to Their Pre-War Level May Be Achieved With a 12mb/d Increase in Hormuz Flows From Current Levels



Yanbu is on the west coast of Saudi Arabia, bordering the Red Sea and connected to Saudi eastern oil fields via the East-West pipeline. Fujairah lies east (outside) of the Strait of Hormuz and is connected to Abu Dhabi's onshore fields via the Abu Dhabi Crude Oil Pipeline (ADCOP). The Gulf of Oman connects the Strait to the Arabian Sea (southeast). The Kirkuk-Ceyhan pipeline allows northern Iraqi crude to be pumped through Turkey to the Mediterranean sea.

Source: Kpler, S&P Global Commodities at Sea, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

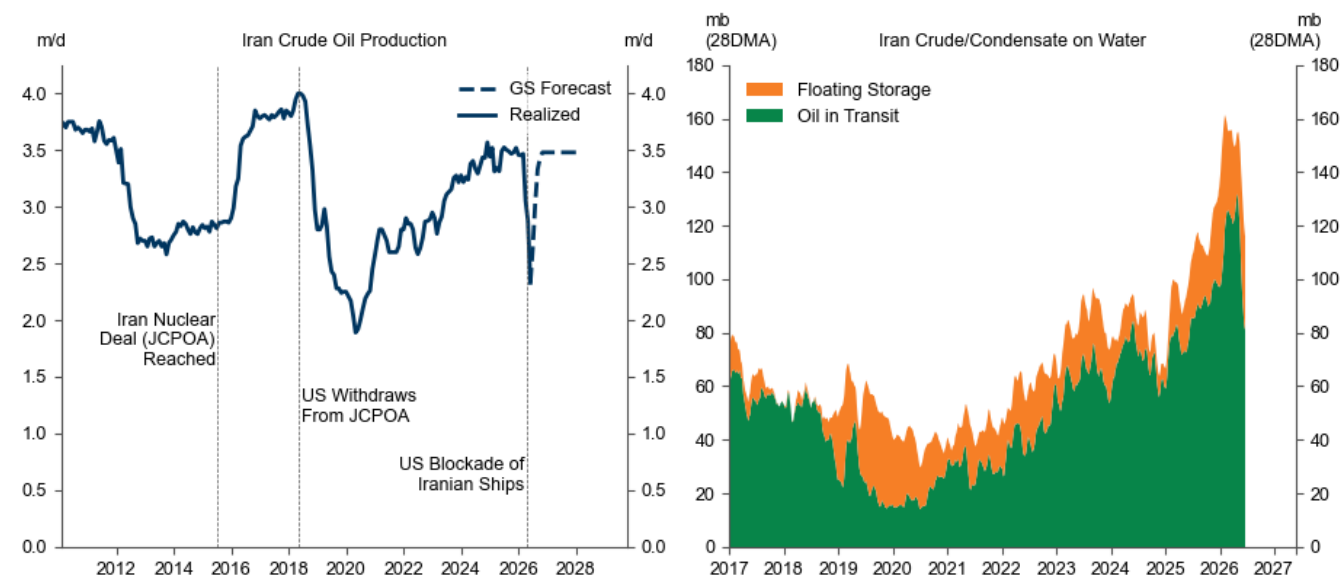
Exhibit 4: Estimated Oil Flows From Persian Gulf Countries Have Trended Up From Less Than 30% of Normal Levels in Early March to Nearly 50% of Normal in Mid-June



Yanbu is on the west coast of Saudi Arabia, bordering the Red Sea and connected to Saudi eastern oil fields via the East-West pipeline. Fujairah lies east (outside) of the Strait of Hormuz and is connected to Abu Dhabi's onshore fields via the Abu Dhabi Crude Oil Pipeline (ADCOP). The Gulf of Oman connects the Strait to the Arabian Sea (southeast). The Kirkuk-Ceyhan pipeline allows northern Iraqi crude to be pumped through Turkey to the Mediterranean sea.

Source: Kpler, S&P Global Commodities at Sea, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

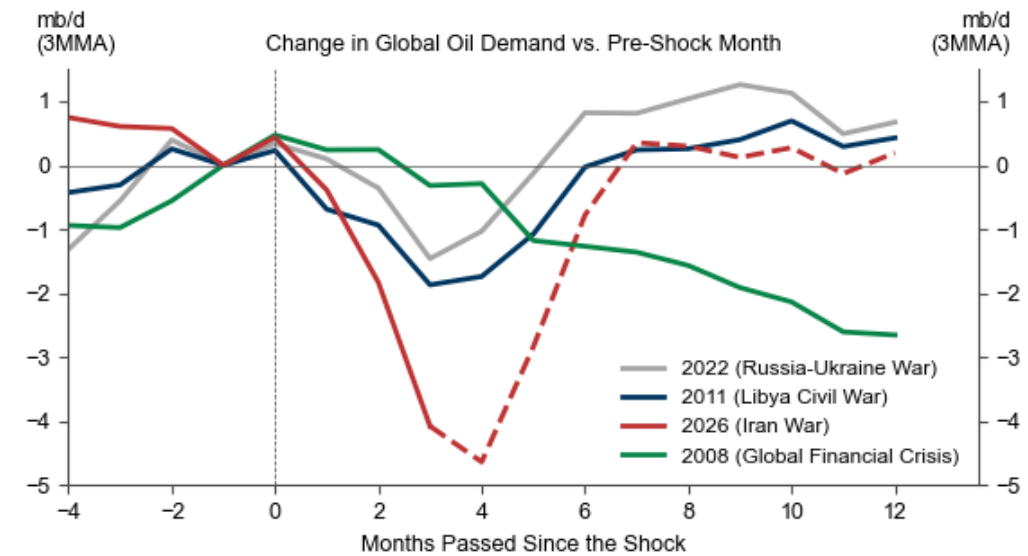
Exhibit 5: Potential Sanctions Relief May Raise Iran Production Above Pre-War Levels and Reduce Oil on Water, Which Remains High at Nearly 120mb



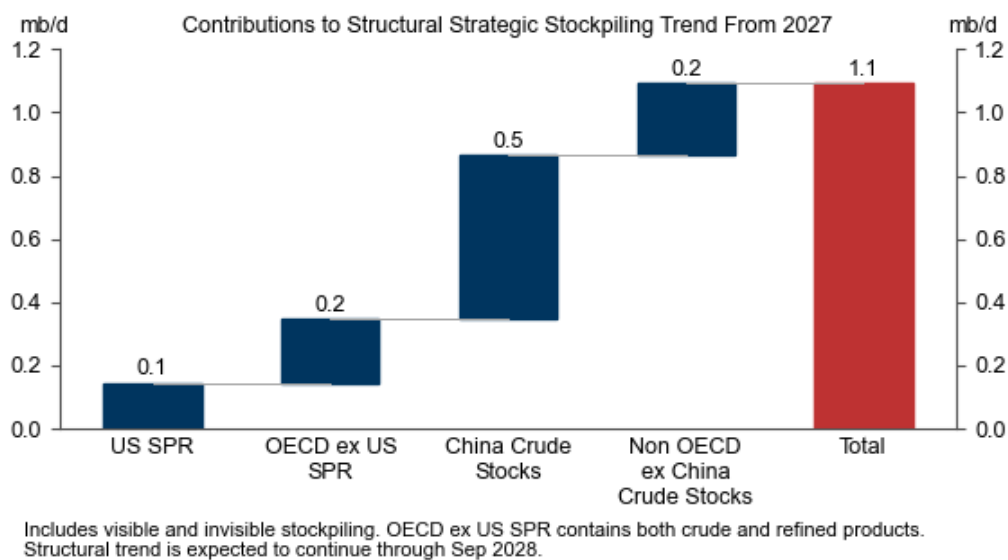
Source: Kpler, IEA, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

A Large 2027 Surplus

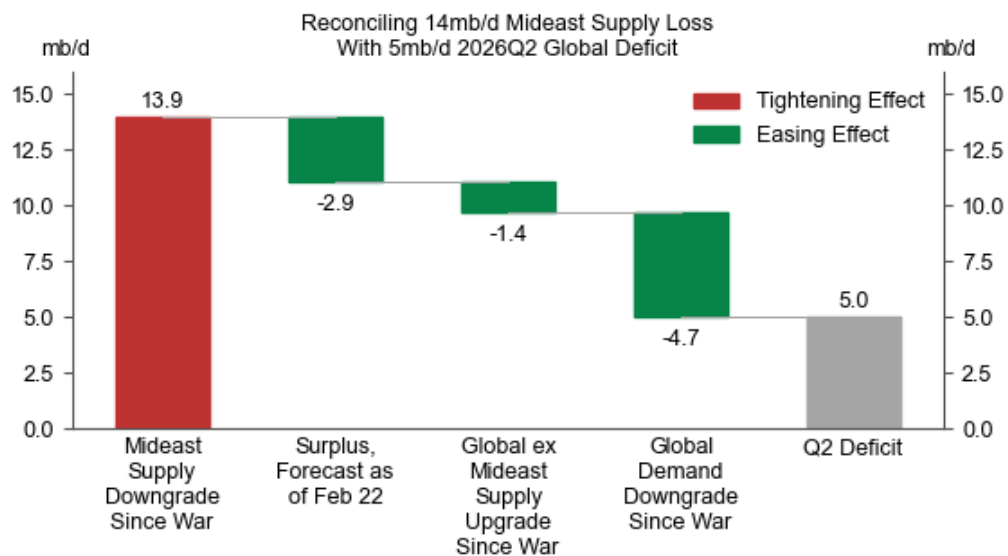
Exhibit 6: Global Oil Demand Tends to Recover Swiftly Following Oil Supply Shocks But Remain Weak Following Recessions



Source: IEA, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 7: We Assume a Structural Trend of Global Strategic Stockpiling of Over 1mb/d in 2027


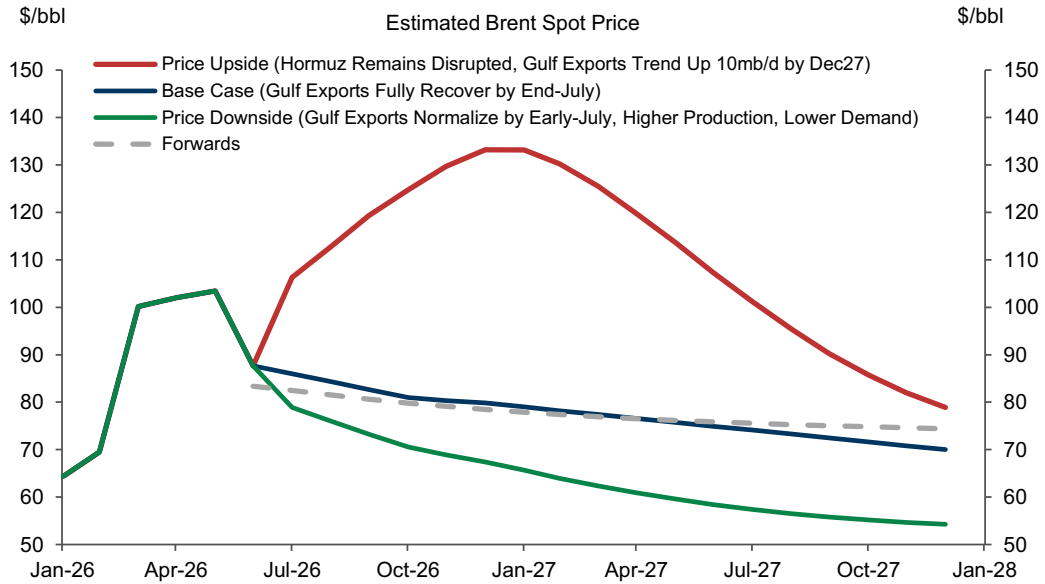
Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 8: We Estimate a 5mb/d Q2 Deficit, Which is Smaller Than the 14mb/d Hit to Mideast Liquids Production


Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Two Sided Risks But Still Net Upside

Exhibit 9: We See Risks to Our Brent Price Forecast as Two-Sided but Tilted to the Upside on Net



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

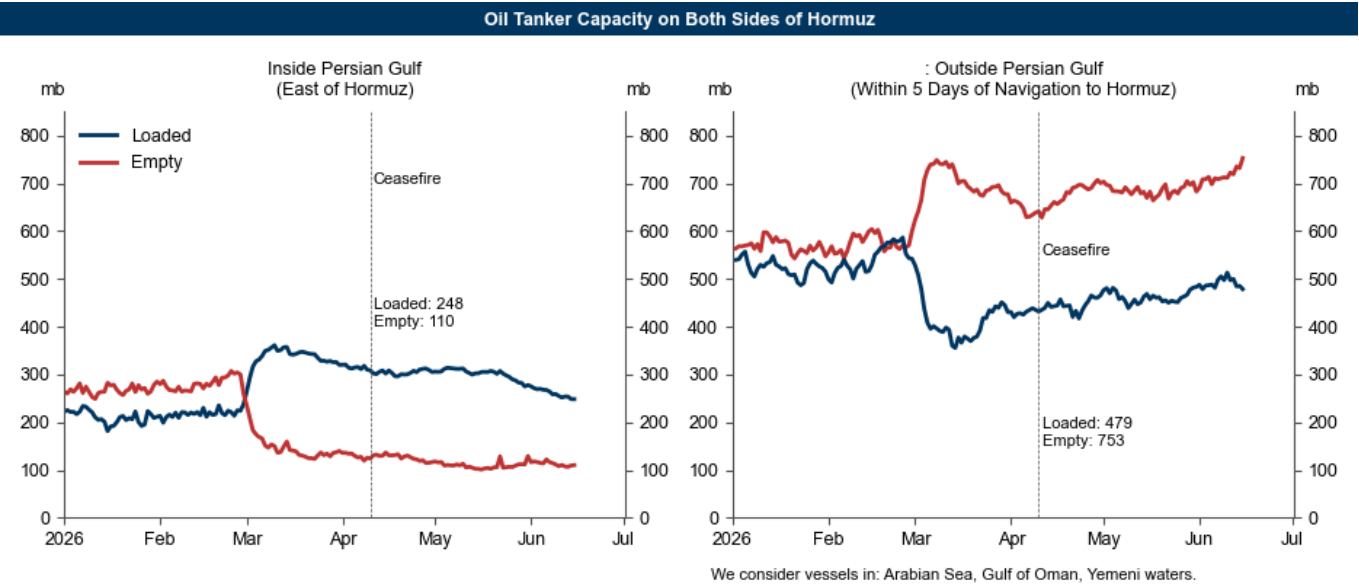
Appendix

Exhibit 10: We Reduce Our 2026Q4 Brent Forecast to \$80 (vs. \$90 Prior) and Our 2027 Average Forecast to \$75 (vs. \$80 Prior)

	Brent (\$/bbl)			WTI (\$/bbl)		
	New GS Forecast	Old GS Forecast	Forwards (Nearby Contract Traded That Month)	New GS Forecast	Old GS Forecast	Forwards (Nearby Contract Traded That Month)
2025	68	68		65	65	
2026	85	90	83	80	85	78
2027	75	80	75	70	75	71
2028	71	75	74	66	70	69
2029	74	75	72	69	70	67
2030	75	75	71	70	70	66
2031-2035	75	75	68	70	70	61
1Q25	75	75	75	71	71	71
2Q25	67	67	67	64	64	64
3Q25	68	68	68	65	65	65
4Q25	63	63	63	59	59	59
1Q26	78	78	76	72	72	72
2Q26	98	100	96	93	95	92
3Q26	84	94	80	79	88	76
4Q26	80	90	78	75	85	74
1Q27	78	86	77	74	81	72
2Q27	76	82	76	71	77	71
3Q27	73	78	75	69	73	71
4Q27	71	75	74	66	70	70
Jan-26	65	65		60	60	
Feb-26	69	69		65	65	
Mar-26	100	100		91	91	
Apr-26	102	102		98	98	
May-26	104	104		99	99	
Jun-26	88	95	81	82	90	79
Jul-26	86	97	81	81	92	77
Aug-26	84	92	80	79	87	76
Sep-26	83	92	79	77	86	75
Oct-26	81	91	78	76	86	74
Nov-26	80	90	78	75	85	74
Dec-26	80	88	77	75	83	73
Jan-27	79	87	77	74	82	73
Feb-27	78	86	77	74	81	72
Mar-27	77	84	76	73	79	72
Apr-27	77	83	76	72	78	72
May-27	76	82	76	71	77	71
Jun-27	75	80	75	70	75	71
Jul-27	74	79	75	70	74	71
Aug-27	73	78	75	69	73	71
Sep-27	72	77	75	68	71	71
Oct-27	72	75	74	67	70	70
Nov-27	71	75	74	66	70	70
Dec-27	70	75	74	65	70	70

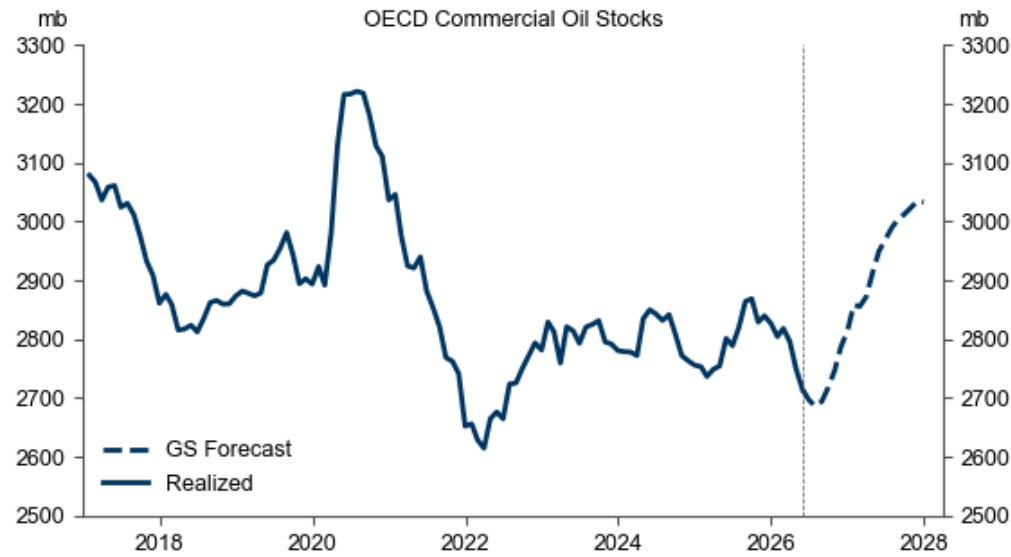
Source: ICE, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 11: We Estimate That Empty Oil Tankers Within the Strait or Within 5 Days of Navigation Have the Capacity to Load 860 Million Barrels



Source: Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 12: We Estimate That OECD Commercial Oil Stocks Will Bottom Out in July at 2,686mb



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 13: We Estimate a Large 5mb/d Deficit in 2026Q2 But a Large 3.2mb/d Surplus in 2027

GS 2025-2027 Oil Supply and Demand Outlook (mb/d)								Quarterly Levels							
	2025		2026		2027			2026				2027			
	Level	YoY	Level	YoY	Level	YoY		Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
World Supply	105.8	3.1	103.4	-2.4	108.9	5.5		103.2	95.1	105.6	109.8	109.2	109.0	108.9	108.6
Non-OPEC ex. Russia Supply	65.8	2.1	66.3	0.5	68.1	1.8		65.2	64.3	67.4	68.3	67.9	68.1	68.2	68.0
Total US	22.3	0.8	23.1	0.7	23.4	0.3		22.4	23.2	23.3	23.3	23.1	23.5	23.5	23.4
Canada	6.4	0.3	6.6	0.2	6.6	0.1		6.5	6.3	6.6	6.8	6.8	6.4	6.6	6.7
Non-OPEC Latam	7.0	0.6	7.9	0.9	8.2	0.3		7.6	8.0	8.0	8.1	8.1	8.1	8.2	8.4
Russia	10.4	-0.2	10.5	0.1	10.1	-0.4		10.4	10.5	10.6	10.5	10.3	10.2	10.0	9.9
OPEC Supply	29.6	1.2	26.6	-3.0	30.8	4.2		27.6	20.2	27.6	31.0	30.9	30.7	30.7	30.7
Saudi crude	9.5	0.5	9.1	-0.4	10.4	1.3		9.2	7.0	9.3	10.8	10.5	10.3	10.3	10.3
OPEC liq. ex. Saudi crude	20.1	0.7	17.5	-2.6	20.4	2.8		18.4	13.3	18.3	20.2	20.4	20.4	20.4	20.4
World Demand	104.4	0.8	103.7	-0.7	105.7	2.1		104.4	100.1	105.1	105.0	105.0	104.9	106.4	106.5
OECD Demand	45.9	0.0	45.8	-0.1	45.7	0.0		45.7	44.6	46.6	46.2	45.8	45.0	46.3	45.9
US	20.7	0.2	20.9	0.2	20.9	0.0		20.9	20.8	21.1	21.0	20.8	20.8	21.1	20.9
OECD Europe	13.4	0.0	13.2	-0.2	13.1	-0.1		12.9	13.0	13.9	13.3	12.9	13.0	13.6	13.0
Non-OECD Demand	58.5	0.8	57.9	-0.6	60.0	2.1		58.7	55.5	58.5	58.8	59.2	59.9	60.1	60.6
China	16.9	0.2	16.3	-0.6	16.7	0.4		17.1	15.2	16.2	16.6	16.7	16.7	16.6	16.7
India	5.9	0.1	5.9	0.0	6.4	0.5		6.1	5.6	5.8	6.1	6.5	6.5	6.1	6.5
Other non-OECD Asia	9.4	0.2	9.4	0.0	9.9	0.4		9.5	9.0	9.5	9.6	9.8	9.8	9.8	10.0
Imbalance (=Supply-Demand)	1.4	2.3	-0.3	-1.7	3.2	3.5		-1.2	-5.0	0.4	4.8	4.2	4.0	2.5	2.1
Change in OECD Comm. Stocks	0.2	-	0.0	-	0.6	-		-0.3	-1.1	0.2	1.1	0.6	1.1	0.5	0.2

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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Reg AC

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